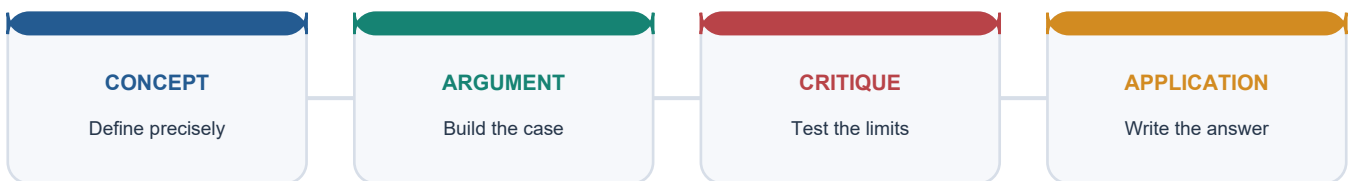


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Sentence Grammar - Qualifying English Learner-v2 Semantic Successor

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Sentence Grammar - Complete Qualifying English Learning Session

Identity: qualifying-english-02:learner-v2:g1 **Generation date:** 2026-09-06 **Approval:** false **Official syllabus anchor:** Usage and Vocabulary; sentence completeness, agreement, tense/aspect, articles/determiners, prepositions, conjunctions, parallelism and modifiers.

Canonical/local source	SHA-256 at generation
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\basic\02_Sentence-Grammar.md	70b64e7a9a972a922f7c4f0d51bf2bdf1813e9d4802a3f98296ef3f1d4a029a2
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\00_Master-Framework.md	6d21958ce3d0da9107bd467ebfffb56f016d91a1ff5d873d3d2af31b1817d15
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md	80723c9ace35be70e1a38f623e6384269824ea68932a696ba97c6381690a9827
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\README.md	cb5fd830a1a1d8d346d37fde4f27ec00e901b478b37136772246abeaaf538a53
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Qualifying-English\subject-wide-package\Qualifying-English_Practice-Solutions.md	9e04b1a14020cc7871448842f207b89d9c649293cab9fffd2ed7fb98118b7fb1

Verification references

- <https://upsc.gov.in/examinations/previous-question-papers>
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/grammar/subject_verb_agreement.html
- https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/punctuation/commas/index.html
- <https://dictionary.cambridge.org/grammar/british-grammar/collective-nouns>
- <https://www.merriam-webster.com/wordplay/singular-nonbinary-they>

The local official-paper evidence establishes recurring demands, not an official answer key. Public usage references were used to challenge absolutes and accepted-variation claims. The canonical repository owner remains the teaching source of truth.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Twelve-panel ASCII master flow

Canonical Basic owner

Sentence Grammar - Core

1. Complete sentences and agreement

A complete sentence needs a finite verb and a complete thought. Repair a fragment (*Because the policy failed*) by attaching it to a main clause. Do not join two complete clauses with a comma alone: use a full stop, semicolon, or coordinating conjunction.

Subject pattern	Verb
singular noun/pronoun	<i>The officer is ready.</i>
plural noun/pronoun	<i>The officers are ready.</i>
each/■every/■either/■neither + singular noun	<i>Each proposal has merit.</i>
each of/■neither of + plural noun	formal default singular: <i>Neither of the alternatives is acceptable.</i> Plural is also common with <i>neither of</i> in modern use; use singular in a correction test unless context requires otherwise.
one of + plural noun	singular: <i>One of the answers is wrong.</i>
a number of / the number of	plural / singular: <i>A number are absent; the number is rising.</i>
amount, period, distance as one unit	singular: <i>Ten kilometres is far to walk.</i>
along with/■as well as/■together with	agrees with first subject: <i>The minister, along with officials, is attending.</i>
either...or/■neither...nor	normally agree with nearer subject: <i>Neither the officers nor the minister is ready.</i> Recast awkward mixed-person subjects: <i>Neither the minister nor the officers are ready.</i>
collective noun	singular unit or plural members; keep pronoun consistent: <i>The team has its plan / are arguing among themselves.</i>
none of + plural/count noun	singular is traditional when "not one"; plural is common when "not any." Choose one form and keep the reference clear: <i>None of the evidence is...; none of the applicants are...</i>
fraction/percentage + of	agree with the noun after of: <i>Half of the work is done; half of the files are missing.</i>
there is/■are	agree with the following real subject: <i>There are two errors; there is one error.</i>
gerund/infinitive clause	usually singular: <i>Reading carefully is essential.</i>

More than one + singular noun normally takes singular (*More than one candidate has applied*). Many a + singular noun also takes singular.

2. Tense and aspect: choose the time relation

Meaning	Form	Example
fact, habit, timetable	simple present	<i>Water freezes at 0 degreesC; the train leaves at six.</i>
action happening now/temporary arrangement	present continuous	<i>She is reading; they are staying in Delhi.</i>
completed action with present result; unfinished time	present perfect	<i>She has submitted the form; I have seen her today.</i>
duration continuing to now	present perfect continuous	<i>He has been working for five days.</i>
completed past at stated/finished time	simple past	<i>She submitted it yesterday; I saw her in 2024.</i>

Meaning	Form	Example
ongoing past interrupted by another event	past continuous	<i>She was reading when I entered.</i>
earlier of two past points	past perfect	<i>The meeting had ended before we arrived.</i> Use it for a needed sequence, not automatically for every past sentence.
duration before a past point	past perfect continuous	<i>They had been waiting for an hour before the bus came.</i>
future prediction/decision	will + base verb	<i>I will call later.</i>
arranged future	present continuous	<i>We are meeting tomorrow.</i>
action in progress at future time	future continuous	<i>This time tomorrow, she will be travelling.</i>
future before a stated future point	future perfect	<i>By June, she will have finished.</i>
duration up to a future point	future perfect continuous	<i>By June, she will have been working here for a year.</i>

State verbs normally avoid continuous forms in their ordinary meanings: *know, believe, understand, own, belong, prefer, need*. Write *I know the rule*, not usually *I am knowing*. Some change meaning: *I think it is right* (opinion) / *I am thinking about it* (considering).

Time clauses and conditionals

Do not ordinarily put *will* after *if, when, until, as soon as, before* for a future condition: *If/when she arrives, I will call*. *Will* is possible when it means willingness: *If you will wait, I will check*.

Type	Form	Meaning/example
Zero	if + present, present	general result: <i>If water freezes, it expands.</i>
First	if + present, will/may/can/imperative	real future: <i>If you revise, you will improve.</i>
Second	if + past form, would/could/might + base	unreal present/future: <i>If I knew, I would tell you.</i> <i>were</i> is safest formal form: <i>If I were you...</i>
Third	if + past perfect, would/could/might have + past participle	unreal past: <i>If she had left earlier, she would have caught the train.</i>
Mixed: past condition, present result	if + past perfect, would + base	<i>If I had taken the job, I would live in Mumbai now.</i>
Mixed: present condition, past result	if + past form, would have + participle	<i>If he were more careful, he would not have made that error.</i>

Do not use *would* in the ordinary if-clause: *If I would know -> If I knew*. With *unless*, use an affirmative condition where it means *if ... not*: *Unless you practise, you will not improve*. Do **not** replace *if* with *unless* if it changes polarity, emphasis, or a negative main-clause meaning.

3. Articles and determiners

Article choice

Use	Example
a/■an = one, non-specific singular count noun	<i>a university; an hour; an MBA graduate</i> - choose by sound, not spelling
the = specific, previously identified, unique in context, superlative/ordinal	<i>the file you sent; the sun; the first answer; the best option</i>
zero article = plural/uncountable in general	<i>Books are useful; Honesty matters; Water is scarce.</i>
institution purpose	<i>go to school/prison/hospital</i> as pupil/prisoner/patient; <i>go to the school/hospital</i> as a building/visitor
geographical names	<i>India, Delhi, Mount Everest</i> ; but <i>the Himalayas, the Ganga, the Indian Ocean, the United States</i>

A singular count noun normally cannot stand bare: She is teacher -> *She is a teacher*. General abstract nouns can take the when qualified: *Freedom is valuable; the freedom guaranteed by law matters*.

Determiners and quantity

Count nouns	Uncountable nouns	Either/other
many, few/a few, fewer, several	much, little/a little, less	some, any, enough, more, most, all, no

few/little means hardly any; a few/a little means some and is positive. Use *fewer candidates* but *less water*; less than ten candidates is common in measurement-style usage but *fewer* is safest in formal correction. much is common in negatives/questions; *a great deal of* is natural in positive statements. Use some in offers/requests expecting yes: *Would you like some tea?*

Determiner contrast	Safe use
each/every	both take singular noun and verb; <i>each</i> views individuals, <i>every</i> the group: <i>Every room; each of the rooms</i>
either/neither	normally one of/not one of two: <i>either answer is; neither answer is</i>
both	plural: <i>both answers are</i>
another/other/the other	one more; additional/different; the remaining one of two: <i>another book; other books; the other book</i>
fewer/less	number of countable items; amount/quantity
amount/number	uncountable quantity; countable items: <i>amount of water; number of books</i>

4. Prepositions, verb patterns and phrasal verbs

Memorise the whole construction. A preposition may vary with meaning; do not invent a universal rule from one example.

Meaning	Safe construction
agree with a person / agree to a plan / agree on a point	<i>I agree with her; they agreed to the proposal.</i>
angry with/at a person; angry at/about an act	Both <i>angry with the contractor</i> and <i>angry at the contractor</i> are standard.
approve of; comply with; consist of; depend on; insist on	<i>comply with the order; insist on verification</i>
abstain from; distinguish X from Y; responsible for	<i>abstain from voting</i>
discuss/enter/approach/reach	no about/■into/■to in ordinary transitive use: <i>discuss the proposal; enter a room; approach the officer; reach Delhi</i>
comprise / consist	<i>The unit comprises five sections; The unit consists of five sections.</i> Avoid <i>comprises of</i> in formal correction.

Meaning	Safe construction
wait for; listen to; belong to; suffer from	<i>wait for a bus; listen to advice</i>

Double objects and provide

Many verbs allow two patterns:

Verb	Pattern 1	Pattern 2
give/send/show/teach	<i>give her the file</i>	<i>give the file to her</i>
buy/make/find	<i>buy her a book</i>	<i>buy a book for her</i>
provide	<i>provide students with meals</i>	<i>provide meals for/to students</i>

Provide someone something is established, especially in North American usage, but is less preferred in conservative British formal prose. It is not a grammar error. In an Indian formal correction answer, prefer one of the two standard provide ... with/for/to patterns unless the question tests a stated house style.

Phrasal/prepositional verbs

Verb	Meaning	Example
look after	care for	<i>look after children</i>
look for	seek	<i>look for evidence</i>
look into	investigate	<i>look into the complaint</i>
look up to	admire	<i>look up to her teacher</i>
put off	postpone	<i>put off the meeting</i>
put up with	tolerate	<i>put up with noise</i>
carry out	perform	<i>carry out an inquiry</i>
bring up	mention/raise	<i>bring up the issue</i>
turn down	reject/reduce	<i>turn down the offer</i>
take over	assume control	<i>take over the office</i>

Separable verb + pronoun: *turn the offer down / turn it down*, not *turn down it*. Do not split inseparable *look after*: *look the child after* is wrong.

5. Conjunctions, parallelism and modifiers

Rule	Correct form
No double conjunction	<i>Although it rained, we left</i> ; not <i>Although... but...</i>
because gives reason; because of takes noun phrase	<i>because it rained / because of rain</i>
despite/in spite of takes noun phrase or <i>the fact that</i> clause	<i>despite the rain; in spite of the fact that it rained</i>
not only...but also needs matched units	<i>not only honest but also efficient; not only reads but also writes</i>
either...or / neither...nor / both...and	match grammar on both sides: <i>either to revise or to withdraw; both accurate and concise</i>
paired list stays parallel	<i>planning, coordinating and monitoring</i>
comparison compares like with like	<i>the population of Delhi is larger than that of Pune</i>

Place a modifier beside its target:

Fault	Repair
Dangling: Walking to office, the rain began.	<i>While I was walking to office, it began to rain.</i>
Misplaced: She served sandwiches to the children on paper plates.	<i>She served the children sandwiches on paper plates.</i>
Squinting: Students who regularly revise improve.	Place <i>regularly</i> beside the intended verb: <i>Students who revise regularly improve.</i>

6. Timed diagnostic

In **10 minutes**, correct and label:

1. A number of applicant is absent.
2. If I would have known, I would have called.
3. She has finished the report yesterday.
4. He went to hospital to visit his friend.
5. Neither the manager nor the clerks is ready.
6. We discussed about how to put up with the delay.
7. The office provided the workers meals.
8. Although he was tired but he worked.
9. Having read the report, the errors were obvious.
10. She turned down it.

Key: 1 *applicants* are [AGR]; 2 *had known* [COND]; 3 *finished* [TNS]; 4 *the hospital* [ART]; 5 *are* [AGR]; 6 *discussed how to put up with...* [PREP]; 7 *accepted, though provided the workers with meals* is safest [VAR]; 8 remove *but* [CONJ]; 9 *Having read the report, I found the errors obvious* [MOD]; 10 *turned it down* [PHR].

Semantic-completeness closure - 2026-09-06

Literal syllabus, ownership and boundary

- **Syllabus demand:** Usage and Vocabulary; sentence completeness, agreement, tense/aspect, articles/determiners, prepositions, conjunctions, parallelism and modifiers.
- **Canonical ownership:** Owns clause completeness, subject-verb agreement, tense/aspect/conditionals, article systems, determiner quantity, verb-preposition patterns, phrasal verbs, conjunctions, parallelism and modifier placement.
- **Cross-topic boundary:** Word-class foundations belong to Topic 01; punctuation choices to Topic 03; correction workflow, voice, narration and transformation to Topic 05.

Complete learner and answer route

1. **Clause completeness:** Distinguish complete clauses, fragments, comma splices and subordinated units.
2. **Agreement controller:** Locate the grammatical subject, ignoring interrupting phrases.
3. **Special agreement:** Handle each/every, number expressions, fractions, there constructions and coordinated subjects.
4. **Tense timeline:** Place events on a timeline before choosing tense and aspect.
5. **Conditionals:** Preserve real/unreal time, polarity and result.
6. **Articles:** Choose a/an by sound, the by identifiability and zero article for general plural/mass reference.
7. **Determiners:** Control few/a few, little/a little, fewer/less, each/every and other/another.
8. **Preposition patterns:** Learn verb/adjective/noun plus preposition as complete constructions.
9. **Phrasal verbs:** Preserve idiomatic meaning and separability.
10. **Conjunction logic:** Match clause type and avoid double conjunctions.
11. **Parallelism and comparison:** Coordinate grammatically equivalent units and compare like with like.
12. **Modifier placement:** Attach opening and internal modifiers to their intended heads.

Authority, variation and hostile-query gate

Every correction must preserve the intended time relation, polarity and meaning. Where usage varies, label the conservative examination form without calling a standard alternative ungrammatical.

The review checked the local official UPSC compulsory-English papers listed in README .md, the repository's verbatim syllabus, the subject-wide solved package, and standard public usage references recorded in the learner successor. It explicitly stress-tested: **fragment; subject-verb agreement; aspect; conditionals; article; determiner; phrasal verb; dangling**.

Prefer plain contemporary formal English. Where more than one standard form is legitimate, state the variation and select a conservative examination form only as a risk-control choice; do not falsely label the alternative ungrammatical.

Progressive practice and timed-paper transfer

1. Foundation: identify the demand and state the governing rule in plain language.
2. Controlled application: correct or construct one sentence and explain the change.
3. Passage/paragraph transfer: preserve meaning, reference, register and logical relation.
4. Hostile test: reject a close option that is grammatical in another meaning or variety.
5. Timed execution: answer, verify, classify the error, and retry a fresh item.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic and core set

Q1. Foundation rule - complete sentence: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A complete sentence normally has a finite verb and a complete independent thought. B. Every phrase beginning with because is complete. C. A comma alone can join any two sentences. D. A heading fragment is always a sentence.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q2. Foundation rule - agreement: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The nearest noun always controls the verb. B. The verb agrees with the grammatical subject, not an intervening noun. C. A prepositional phrase changes the subject's number. D. As well as creates a plural subject.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q3. Foundation rule - either-or: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The verb must always be singular. B. The verb must always be plural. C. With either...or or neither...nor, the verb normally agrees with the nearer subject. D. The first subject always controls.

Correct answer: C. Recast awkward mixed-person combinations.

Q4. Foundation rule - tense: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Present perfect is required with yesterday. B. Past perfect is required for every past event. C. Present continuous expresses every habit. D. Use simple past with a finished past-time marker such as yesterday.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q5. Foundation rule - conditionals: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use past perfect plus would have for an unreal past condition and result. B. Use would in the ordinary if-clause. C. Unless always preserves any negative sentence. D. A universal truth must backshift.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q6. Foundation rule - future time clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use will in both clauses. B. Use present form after when or if for an ordinary future condition. C. Use past perfect after every when. D. Delete the time conjunction.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q7. Foundation rule - articles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a before every consonant letter. B. Use an before university. C. Choose a/an by sound, not spelling. D. Use a before hour.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q8. Foundation rule - zero article: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Every abstract noun needs the. B. Every geographical name takes the. C. A singular count noun is normally bare. D. Use zero article for plural or uncountable nouns in a general sense.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q9. Foundation rule - determiners: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use fewer for countable items and less for mass quantity in conservative formal prose. B. Use less for every plural noun. C. Few and a few have identical force. D. Much is the only possible positive quantifier.

Correct answer: A. Measurement-style less than ten is established.

Q10. Foundation rule - prepositions: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All verbs require about before a topic. B. Learn the whole pattern: comply with, insist on, consist of and discuss something. C. Comprise must be followed by of. D. Reach requires to before a place.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q11. Foundation rule - phrasal verbs: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All phrasal verbs are separable. B. Write turn down it. C. Place an object pronoun inside a separable phrasal verb: turn it down. D. Split look after as look the child after.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q12. Foundation rule - modifiers: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The nearest noun outside the clause is enough. B. Dangling modifiers are only punctuation errors. C. A passive clause always repairs a dangling modifier. D. An opening participial phrase must logically modify the grammatical subject.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q13. Editing decision - complete sentence: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A complete sentence normally has a finite verb and a complete independent thought. B. Every phrase beginning with because is complete. C. A comma alone can join any two sentences. D. A heading fragment is always a sentence.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q14. Editing decision - agreement: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The nearest noun always controls the verb. B. The verb agrees with the grammatical subject, not an intervening noun. C. A prepositional phrase changes the subject's number. D. As well as creates a plural subject.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q15. Editing decision - either-or: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The verb must always be singular. B. The verb must always be plural. C. With either...or or neither...nor, the verb normally agrees with the nearer subject. D. The first subject always controls.

Correct answer: C. Recast awkward mixed-person combinations.

Q16. Editing decision - tense: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Present perfect is required with yesterday. B. Past perfect is required for every past event. C. Present continuous expresses every habit. D. Use simple past with a finished past-time marker such as yesterday.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Progressive transfer exercises with model answers

Transfer 1. Repair the fragment: "Because the records were incomplete."

Model answer: Attach a main clause: "Because the records were incomplete, the audit was postponed."

Transfer 2. Correct: "The list of pending cases are on the desk."

Model answer: The list of pending cases is on the desk.

Transfer 3. Correct: "She has submitted the form yesterday."

Model answer: She submitted the form yesterday.

Transfer 4. Complete: "If I earlier, I would have attended."

Model answer: had known

Transfer 5. Choose article: "He is honest officer and university graduate."

Model answer: an honest officer and a university graduate

Transfer 6. Correct: "We discussed about the proposal."

Model answer: We discussed the proposal.

Transfer 7. Correct: "Although the road was flooded but buses continued."

Model answer: Although the road was flooded, buses continued.

Transfer 8. Repair the modifier: "Having reviewed the file, the error was obvious."

Model answer: Having reviewed the file, the officer found the error obvious.

Remediation protocol

1. State the rule or passage evidence before looking at the options.
2. Explain why each close distractor fails in this context.
3. Record accepted variation separately from genuine error.
4. Rewrite one fresh sentence or paragraph using the same principle.
5. Advance only after two consecutive correct timed attempts.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified local official-paper demand ledger

Year	Local official paper	Demand routed to this topic	Provenance status
2018	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMP_00.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2019	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-EnglishCompulsory.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2020	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH (1).pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2021	books\more_previous_papers\English.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2022	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-ENGLISH-Compulsory-280922.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2023	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-290923.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2025	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-QP-CSM-25-010925.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required

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Timed hostile set

Q33. Timed-paper choice - determiners: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use fewer for countable items and less for mass quantity in conservative formal prose. B. Use less for every plural noun. C. Few and a few have identical force. D. Much is the only possible positive quantifier.

Correct answer: A. Measurement-style less than ten is established.

Q34. Timed-paper choice - prepositions: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All verbs require about before a topic. B. Learn the whole pattern: comply with, insist on, consist of and discuss something. C. Comprise must be followed by of. D. Reach requires to before a place.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q35. Timed-paper choice - phrasal verbs: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All phrasal verbs are separable. B. Write turn down it. C. Place an object pronoun inside a separable phrasal verb: turn it down. D. Split look after as look the child after.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q36. Timed-paper choice - modifiers: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The nearest noun outside the clause is enough. B. Dangling modifiers are only punctuation errors. C. A passive clause always repairs a dangling modifier. D. An opening participial phrase must logically modify the grammatical subject.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q37. Hostile variation check - complete sentence: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A complete sentence normally has a finite verb and a complete independent thought. B. Every phrase beginning with because is complete. C. A comma alone can join any two sentences. D. A heading fragment is always a sentence.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q38. Hostile variation check - agreement: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The nearest noun always controls the verb. B. The verb agrees with the grammatical subject, not an intervening noun. C. A prepositional phrase changes the subject's number. D. As well as creates a plural subject.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q39. Hostile variation check - either-or: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. The verb must always be singular. B. The verb must always be plural. C. With either...or or neither...nor, the verb normally agrees with the nearer subject. D. The first subject always controls.

Correct answer: C. Recast awkward mixed-person combinations.

Q40. Hostile variation check - tense: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Present perfect is required with yesterday. B. Past perfect is required for every past event. C. Present continuous expresses every habit. D. Use simple past with a finished past-time marker such as yesterday.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Register-sensitive refinements

- *Neither of the answers is* is the safest conservative examination form, while plural agreement occurs in current usage.
- *Less than ten candidates* occurs in measurement-style contexts; *fewer than ten candidates* is the safest formal correction where individuals are counted.
- Present perfect normally resists a finished-time adverb such as *yesterday*, but remains correct with unfinished periods such as *today* when the period is still open.
- *Provide someone something* is established, especially in North American English; prefer *provide someone with something* in conservative Indian formal prose without labelling the other form universally wrong.

Adversarial checks

Test mixed-person either/or subjects, state verbs with changed meanings, future time clauses, institutional zero article, inseparable phrasal verbs, correlative parallelism and modifiers whose logical subject is absent.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Rapid reconstruction spine

- **Clause completeness:** Distinguish complete clauses, fragments, comma splices and subordinated units.
- **Agreement controller:** Locate the grammatical subject, ignoring interrupting phrases.
- **Special agreement:** Handle each/every, number expressions, fractions, there constructions and coordinated subjects.
- **Tense timeline:** Place events on a timeline before choosing tense and aspect.
- **Conditionals:** Preserve real/unreal time, polarity and result.
- **Articles:** Choose a/an by sound, the by identifiability and zero article for general plural/mass reference.
- **Determiners:** Control few/a few, little/a little, fewer/less, each/every and other/another.
- **Preposition patterns:** Learn verb/adjective/noun plus preposition as complete constructions.
- **Phrasal verbs:** Preserve idiomatic meaning and separability.
- **Conjunction logic:** Match clause type and avoid double conjunctions.
- **Parallelism and comparison:** Coordinate grammatically equivalent units and compare like with like.
- **Modifier placement:** Attach opening and internal modifiers to their intended heads.

Ownership, variation and answer firewall

- **Own here:** Owns clause completeness, subject-verb agreement, tense/aspect/conditionals, article systems, determiner quantity, verb-preposition patterns, phrasal verbs, conjunctions, parallelism and modifier placement.
- **Route elsewhere:** Word-class foundations belong to Topic 01; punctuation choices to Topic 03; correction workflow, voice, narration and transformation to Topic 05.
- **Verification rule:** Every correction must preserve the intended time relation, polarity and meaning. Where usage varies, label the conservative examination form without calling a standard alternative ungrammatical.
- Prefer the smallest defensible correction; preserve meaning and label accepted variants.
- In passage work, cite the text. In precis, add nothing. In essays, invent no quotation or statistic.

Timed-paper spine

READ DEMAND -> MAP STRUCTURE -> APPLY RULE -> CHECK MEANING -> FLAG VARIATION -> REVISE